

LIVE

Learning Space

NEWSPAPER

22nd January, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

4th WEEK



INDIA-ISRAEL ... 25 YEARS

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... BILATERAL, REGIONAL, GLOBAL GROUPINGS AND AGREEMENTS INVOLVING INDIA



Learning Space

LIVE



NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS ... DISCUSSION

22nd JANUARY, 2018

On a new keel

With Benjamin Netanyahu's visit, India and Israel have fully normalised bilateral ties

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's visit to India this week was the final step in the process of fully normalising the bilateral relationship. That process began in 1992 when India established diplomatic ties with Israel, with major milestones in 2003 when Ariel Sharon became the first Israeli Prime Minister to visit India, in 2005 when President Pranab Mukherjee visited Israel, and in 2007 when Narendra Modi became the first Indian Prime Minister to visit Israel. With Mr. Netanyahu's six-day visit, the focus is now on the future, and their joint statement drew a 25-year timeline in which to realise the potential of the strategic partnership. The close personal equation between the two leaders was evident throughout the visit, with Mr. Modi hosting Mr. and Mrs. Netanyahu in Gujarat, where they flew Kites and took part in a roadshow. Mr. Netanyahu also made the traditional trip to the Taj Mahal, and a symbolic journey to Mumbai's Chabad House, one of the sites of the 26/11 terror attacks where Israeli citizens were among those killed. On business, Mr. Modi welcomed Israeli partnership in Indian manufacturing, pointing to the winning combination of an India that has "size and scale" and an Israel that has "sharpness and edge". Mr. Netanyahu's case, made at a speech inaugurating the Foreign Ministry's annual Raisina Dialogue, was that the two countries have a "natural partnership" and a "natural friendship" that also caters to their need for hard power.

With a relationship that is more open, India has also decided to have a more honest conversation with Israel on the peace process. While the Modi-Netanyahu meeting in July 2017 had practically brushed aside the Israel-Palestine peace process, the joint statement issued on Monday in New Delhi "reaffirmed their support for an early resumption of peace talks between Israelis and Palestinians". This indicates that the two Prime Ministers had a deeper conversation on the issue this time, including India's vote at the UN against the decision of the United States to recognise Jerusalem as Israel's capital. Mr. Modi is expected to visit Ramallah as well as meet Jordan's King Abdullah II, who as the custodian of the holy sites in Jerusalem is leading peace efforts in the Arab world, and is due in New Delhi shortly. This would take forward India's commitment to assisting in finding a just solution for the conflict. It will require using the leverage India has built over the decades among Israelis and Palestinians in order to join global and regional powers in pushing them back to the negotiating table. It will also involve challenging Mr. Netanyahu's contention that struck a jarring note in his otherwise successful visit. He said: "The weak don't survive. The strong survive. You make peace with the strong. You ally with the strong." India must stick to its strategy of strengthening ties with Israel without damaging its commitment to the West Asian peace process, and build its friendships and alignments in a way that goes beyond an appraisal of strengths and weaknesses.

20th January, 2018

2 On a new keel

With Benjamin Netanyahu's visit, India and Israel have fully normalised bilateral ties. Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's visit to India this week was the final step in the process of fully normalising the bilateral relationship. That process began in 1992 when India established diplomatic ties with Israel, with major milestones in 2003 when Ariel Sharon became the first Israeli Prime Minister to visit India, in 2015 when President Pranab Mukherjee visited Israel, and in 2017 when Narendra Modi became the first Indian Prime Minister to visit Israel. With Mr. Netanyahu's six-day visit, the focus is now on the future, and their joint statement drew a 25-year timeline in which to realise the potential of the strategic partnership. The close personal equation between the two leaders was evident throughout the visit, with Mr. Modi hosting Mr. and Ms. Netanyahu in Gujarat, where they flew kites and took part in a roadshow. Mr. Netanyahu also made the traditional trip to the Taj Mahal, and a symbolic journey to Mumbai's Chabad House, one of the sites of the 26/11 terror attacks where Israeli citizens were among those killed. On business, Mr. Modi welcomed Israeli partnership in Indian manufacturing, pointing to the winning combination of an India that has "size and scale" and an Israel that has "sharpness and edge". Mr. Netanyahu's case, made at a speech inaugurating the Foreign Ministry's annual Raisina Dialogue, was that the two countries have a "natural partnership" and a "natural friendship" that also caters to their need for hard power.

2 On a new keel

...Contd.

THE  HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

20th January, 2018

With a relationship that is more open, India has also decided to have a more honest conversation with Israel on the peace process. While the Modi-Netanyahu meeting in July 2017 had practically brushed aside the Israel-Palestine peace process, the joint statement issued on Monday in New Delhi “reaffirmed their support for an early resumption of peace talks between Israelis and Palestinians”. This indicates that the two Prime Ministers had a deeper conversation on the issue this time, including India’s vote at the UN against the decision of the United States to recognise Jerusalem as Israel’s capital. Mr. Modi is expected to visit Ramallah as well as meet Jordan’s King Abdullah II, who as the custodian of the holy sites in Jerusalem is leading peace efforts in the Arab world, and is due in New Delhi shortly. This would take forward India’s commitment to assisting in finding a just solution for the conflict. It will require using the leverage India has built over the decades among Israelis and Palestinians in order to join global and regional powers in pushing them back to the negotiating table. It will also involve challenging Mr. Netanyahu’s contention that struck a jarring note in his otherwise successful visit. He said: “The weak don’t survive. The strong survive. You make peace with the strong. You ally with the strong.” India must stick to its strategy of strengthening ties with Israel without damaging its commitment to the West Asian peace process, and build its friendships and alignments in a way that goes beyond an appraisal of strengths and weaknesses.

2

On a new keel

With Benjamin Netanyahu's visit, India and Israel have fully normalised bilateral ties

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's visit to India this week was the final step in the process of fully normalising the bilateral relationship. That process began in 1992 when India established diplomatic ties with Israel, with major milestones in 2003 when Ariel Sharon became the first Israeli Prime Minister to visit India, in 2015 when President Pranab Mukherjee visited Israel, and in 2017 when Narendra Modi became the first Indian Prime Minister to visit Israel. With Mr. Netanyahu's six-day visit, the focus is now on the future, and their joint statement drew a 25-year timeline in which to realise the potential of the strategic partnership. The close personal equation between the two leaders was evident throughout the visit, with Mr. Modi hosting Mr. and Ms. Netanyahu in Gujarat, where they flew kites and took part in a roadshow. Mr. Netanyahu also made the traditional trip to the Taj Mahal, and a symbolic journey to Mumbai's Chabad House, one of the sites of the 26/11 terror attacks where Israeli citizens were among those killed. On business, Mr. Modi welcomed Israeli partnership in Indian manufacturing, pointing to the winning combination of an India that has "size and scale" and an Israel that has "sharpness and edge". Mr. Netanyahu's case, made at a speech inaugurating the Foreign Ministry's annual Raisina Dialogue, was that the two countries have a "natural partnership" and a "natural friendship" that also caters to their need for hard power.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

20th January, 2018

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... BILATERAL, REGIONAL, GLOBAL
GROUPINGS AND AGREEMENTS
INVOLVING INDIA

IMPORTANT QUESTION

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

Critically examine 25 years of
diplomatic relations between India and
Israel.



Cyprus

SYRIA

Mediterranean Sea

ISRAEL

LEBANON

Sea of Galilee

Jordan River

Dead Sea

IRAQ

JORDAN

EGYPT

SAUDI ARABIA

Gulf of Aqaba



HISTORY OF INDIA-ISRAEL RELATIONS

- 1 The process for normalising the ties started with P.V. Narasimha Rao's Prime Ministership in 1992, when India established diplomatic ties with Israel.
- 2 In 2003, Ariel Sharon became the first Israeli Prime Minister to visit India.
- 3 In 2015, President Pranab Mukherjee visited Israel. In 2017, Narendra Modi became the first Prime Minister to visit Israel.

Personal equation now became evident, when both the leaders flew kites and took part in a road show.



INDIA-ISRAEL ... 25 YEARS

- 1 Improvement in India's ties with USA.
- 2 Reduction of the tensions between Israel and Arab States in recent times.
- 3 The Centres of Excellence in agriculture began in 2009 and now exist in large number of Indian States.

During the past 25 years, the divergence between India and Israel reduced considerably.



Defense, Agriculture cooperation and education are on the increase.

INDIA-ISRAEL ... 25 YEARS

- 4 Several States are coming forward to seek Israel assistance in agriculture. Punjab is keen to seek Israeli assistance in drip irrigation.
- 5 There is Olive Plantation Initiative in Rajasthan by Israel.
- 6 Israel is India's third largest arms supplier.
- 7 Trade is at around \$ 5 billion per annum. Israeli Foreign Direct Investment is estimated to be over \$ 100 billion during the past 16 years.



TAKEOUTS FROM THIS VISIT

- 1 Both the leaders flew the kites and took part in the roadshow. Mr. Netanyahu made traditional trip to Taj Mahal, and symbolic journey to Mumbai's Chabad House, one of the sites of the 26/11 terror attacks, where Israeli citizens were among those killed.
- 2 Mr. Modi welcomed Israeli partnership in Indian manufacturing. The PM said that India has "size and scale" and Israel has "sharpness and edge".
- 3 Mr. Netanyahu said the two countries have "natural partnership" and "natural friendship".



The Joint Statement during July 2017 visit to Israel by the Prime Minister brushed aside the Palestine Peace Process, but now it seems to have been revived.

INDIA...BACK TO THE CONVENTIONAL TONE!

- 1 The Joint Statement reaffirmed New Delhi's support for early resumption of peace talks between Israelis and Palestinians.
- 2 Probably the two leaders had a deeper conversation on the issue, including India's vote at the United Nations, against the decision of the United States to recognise Jerusalem as Israel's capital.
- 3 Mr. Modi is expected to visit Ramallah this year.
- 4 Jordan's King Abdullah II, who is the custodian of holy sites in Jerusalem is expected to visit Delhi. Mr. Abdullah is leading the peace efforts in the Arab world.



Benjamin Netanyahu
Prime Minister, Israel

The Statement of Netanyahu “The weak don’t survive. The strong survive, You make peace with the strong. You ally with the strong.” This should not damage India’s commitment to the West Asian Peace Process.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

Amrita Naidu

D. Sunil Kumar

L. V. Krishna

D. Chaitanya

K. Srikanth

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 - 2 4 4 4 7 2

0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9